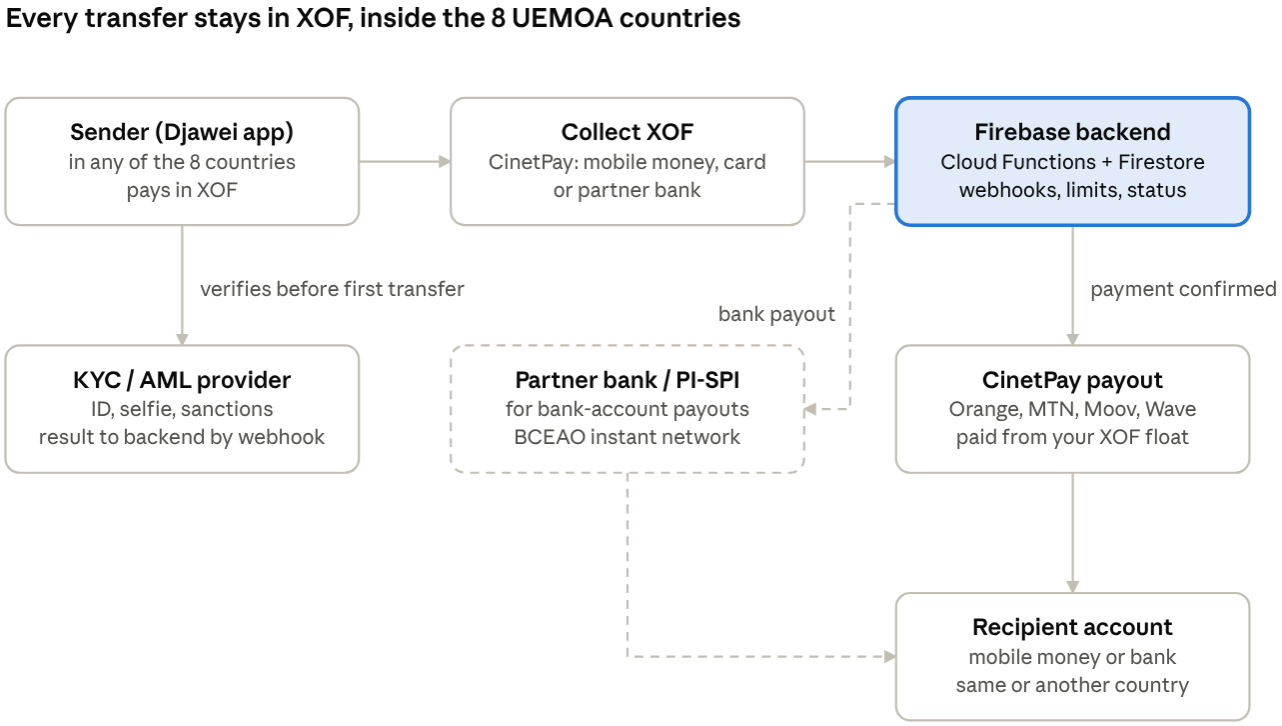
Djawei — Third-Party Services Setup Guide

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Overview

Djawei moves money between Côte d'Ivoire, Senegal, Benin, Togo, Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger and Guinea-Bissau. All 8 share one currency (XOF) and one central bank (BCEAO), so there is no exchange rate and one licence covers the whole zone.



money flow · UEMOA, XOF only

The sender pays in XOF by mobile money, bank or card; Firebase Cloud Functions confirm the payment and trigger the payout to the recipient's wallet or bank account, in the same or another country. The KYC provider verifies the sender before the first transfer.

Set up in this order: BCEAO licence or partner → Firebase → KYC → mobile money → bank / PI-SPI → cards → messaging → app stores.

Step 1 — BCEAO licence and legal foundation

Do this first: in UEMOA, transferring money for customers is a regulated payment service, and the BCEAO (the central bank of all 8 countries) must approve whoever provides it.

1. **Pick your licensing route.**

- Fastest: work as a **partner or agent of an institution that is already approved** (a bank, an e-money issuer such as an operator's mobile-money company, or an approved payment institution). The BCEAO publishes the list of approved payment institutions (list at 31 Aug 2026).
- Long-term: apply for your own approval (*agrément*) as a **payment institution (établissement de paiement)** or **e-money institution (EME)** under BCEAO Instruction n°001-01-2024 on payment services (text). One approval covers the whole UMOA.

2. **Register the company** in one UEMOA country (e.g. Côte d'Ivoire or Senegal) and open a local business bank account.
3. **Customer funds:** keep customer money in a separate, protected account at a bank, as the BCEAO rules require.
4. **AML/CFT:** write your anti-money-laundering policy to the BCEAO / Banking Commission rules (Instruction n°001-03-2025 on AML obligations), and register with each country's **CENTIF** (financial intelligence unit) as required.
5. **Data protection:** each country has its own data authority (e.g. ARTCI in Côte d'Ivoire, CDP in Senegal). Declare your processing and sign data agreements with every provider.
6. **Appoint a compliance officer** — partners and the BCEAO will ask who it is.

Done when: you have an approval or a signed partner agreement, a protected customer-funds account and a written AML policy.

This is not legal advice — confirm the route with a UEMOA payments lawyer before you apply.

Step 2 — Firebase backend (Blaze plan)

Firebase stays your backend; it must be on the pay-as-you-go **Blaze** plan because Cloud Functions have to call CinetPay, the KYC provider and banks.

1. Create two projects: **djawei-dev** and **djawei-prod**. Pick the region closest to your users that your lawyer accepts for data storage (e.g. `europe-west1`).
2. Upgrade to **Blaze** and set a **budget alert** in Google Cloud Billing.
3. Register the apps (`com.djawei` on Android and iOS); put `google-services.json` in `android/app/` and `GoogleService-Info.plist` in `ios/Djawei/`.
4. **Authentication:** Phone (main login in West Africa), Email/Password, Google and Apple.
5. **Firestore collections:** `users` (with `country`), `recipients`, `receivingAccounts`, `transfers` (from country, to country, amount in XOF, fee, method, status), `devices`, `notifications`. Security rules: users read only their own data and can never change a

transfer's status.

6. **Cloud Functions** hold all money logic: create transfer, check limits, call the payment provider, receive webhooks, trigger payout, update status, send push.
7. **Secret Manager** for every API key; **App Check**, **Crashlytics**, **Analytics** and **Cloud Messaging** turned on (free).
8. In the app: install `@react-native-firebase/*`, then replace `src/data/mock.ts` and `AppDataContext` with Firestore reads and Cloud Function calls.

Cost: free quota first, then pay per use. **Phone-auth SMS is billed per message**, and West African numbers usually cost more than European ones.

Step 3 — KYC and AML

One provider should handle ID document, selfie liveness and sanctions screening; it powers the three Identity verification screens.

1. Shortlist **Sumsub**, **Veriff**, **Onfido (Entrust)** or an African specialist such as **Smile ID** (strong on West African IDs). Public estimates are about **$1–3 per check**, often with a monthly minimum.
2. Check document coverage for all 8 countries: national ID (CNI), passport, consular card, and biometric voter/ECOWAS cards where used.
3. Sign the contract and data agreement; get **sandbox** keys.
4. Integrate their **React Native SDK** from the KYC screens; a Cloud Function creates the applicant and token.
5. A **webhook** Cloud Function sets `users/{uid}.kycStatus` (`pending`, `approved`, `rejected`).
6. Turn on **sanctions/PEP screening** and ongoing monitoring.
7. Tie limits to KYC level in Cloud Functions (the app's demo shows 2,000,000 XOF/month before verification and 10,000,000 XOF after — set the real figures with your licensed partner).

Done when: a test user goes from "Action needed" to "Approved" through the webhook.

Step 4 — Mobile money: collect and pay out (main rail)

Most of your volume will be mobile money, so one aggregator that covers Orange Money, MTN MoMo, Moov Money and Wave in all 8 countries is the core of the system.

1. Open a merchant account with **CinetPay** (main) and get a quote from **PayDunya** as backup (fee comparison). Confirm in writing which operators they support **for both collection and payout in each of the 8 countries** — coverage in Guinea-Bissau and

Niger is usually thinner.

2. Submit company documents and your licence/partner proof from Step 1; enable the **payment (collection) API** and the **transfer (payout) API**.
3. Build Cloud Functions:
   - `createPayment` — opens the operator checkout (the app's CinetPay screen, where the sender confirms with their operator PIN or USSD).
   - `paymentWebhook` — marks the transfer "paid".
   - `payout` — sends the money to the recipient's wallet in the destination country.
   - `payoutWebhook` — marks it "completed" or "failed" and triggers a refund if needed.
4. **Float (prefunding):** aggregators pay out from a balance you keep with them. Plan enough XOF float for a day or two of payouts, and a daily top-up routine.
5. **Daily reconciliation:** money collected vs payouts sent vs float balance.
6. Later, at high volume, sign directly with **Wave Business**, **Orange Money** and **MTN MoMo** in your biggest corridors for lower fees.

Cost model: a percentage per collection and per payout, varying by country and operator. Your 1% demo fee in the app must cover both.

Step 5 — Bank transfers and PI-SPI

For bank accounts, the BCEAO's instant-payment platform **PI-SPI**, live since 30 September 2025, links banks and mobile-money issuers across all 8 countries (BCEAO launch).

1. **Short term:** use your aggregator's bank-transfer payout, or a partner bank (e.g. a pan-UEMOA bank such as Ecobank, Orabank, Coris or Société Générale) for bank payouts.
2. **Medium term:** ask your partner bank or approved institution to connect you to **PI-SPI**, so a transfer to any bank or wallet in the zone settles instantly. Only BCEAO-approved participants connect directly; as a newcomer you go through a participant.
3. Build Cloud Functions for bank payout, account-name check (to avoid wrong-account payments) and status webhooks, like Step 4.
4. For senders paying **from** a bank account (the app's "Bank app" approval screen), use the bank's or aggregator's payment link / request-to-pay.

Cost model: per-transfer fee set by the bank or participant; ask for PI-SPI pricing when you negotiate.

Step 6 — Card payments (Visa, Mastercard, GIM-UEMOA)

Cards are a smaller share in the region, so add them through the same aggregator rather than a separate gateway.

1. Ask **CinetPay** (or PayDunya) to enable **card acceptance** on your account, including 3-D Secure; confirm they accept local **GIM-UEMOA** cards as well as Visa and Mastercard.
2. The app's "Card verification" screen maps to their hosted 3-D Secure page; a Cloud Function creates the payment and a webhook confirms it.
3. Test approvals and declines (the app's "Payment not successful" screen).
4. Never store card numbers yourself — the gateway handles them (PCI DSS).

Cost model: usually a higher percentage than mobile money; check it before offering cards with the same fee.

Step 7 — SMS, email, push and live chat

These power the OTP, alert and support screens; SMS matters most because phone numbers are the main identity in the region.

1. **SMS OTP:** start with **Firebase Phone Auth**. If delivery to some operators is poor, add a regional SMS provider or **Twilio Verify** (both bill per SMS). Test every country's main operators.
2. **WhatsApp (optional):** many users prefer WhatsApp for alerts and support; the WhatsApp Business API is billed per conversation.
3. **Email:** Firebase sends password-reset emails free; for receipts use **Brevo**, **SendGrid** or **Resend**.
4. **Push: Firebase Cloud Messaging** (free); upload your Apple APNs key to Firebase.
5. **Live chat: Crisp** (free tier) or **Intercom / Zendesk**, in French and English.
6. **Support line:** a local number in your home country (the app shows +225) and support@djawei.com.

Step 8 — App stores and sign-in

Open the store accounts early: Apple's organisation verification can take weeks.

1. **Apple Developer Program** — $99/year, enrol as an organisation (needs a D-U-N-S number).
2. **Google Play Console** — $25 one-time, organisation account. Most of your users will be on Android, so optimise for low-end phones and slow networks.
3. **Sign in with Apple** — free, but **required on iOS** if you keep Google sign-in.
4. Store listings in **French and English**, a privacy policy URL, and the financial-services declarations both stores ask for (licence or partner details from Step 1).
5. Release through TestFlight / Play internal testing with real users in at least 2–3 of the countries before going public.

Cost summary

Most costs scale with transfers; fixed costs are the store accounts, domain, any provider minimums and the payout float. Figures are indicative — get written quotes.

Service	Provider (suggested)	Pricing model	Needed at launch
Licence / legal	BCEAO approval or approved partner	Partner fee, or approval + legal fees	Yes
Backend	Firebase Blaze	Pay-as-you-go after free quota	Yes
Mobile money collect + payout	CinetPay (PayDunya backup)	% per collection and per payout + XOF float	Yes
Bank transfers	Partner bank / PI-SPI participant	Per-transfer fee	Yes
Cards	Through CinetPay	% per payment	Optional at launch
KYC / AML	Sumsub, Veriff or Smile ID	~$1–3 per check + possible minimum	Yes
SMS OTP	Firebase Phone Auth / Twilio	Per SMS	Yes
Email	Brevo / SendGrid / Resend	Free tier, then monthly	Yes
Push	Firebase Cloud Messaging	Free	Yes
Live chat / WhatsApp	Crisp / WhatsApp Business API	Free tier / per conversation	Optional
Apple Developer	Apple	$99 / year	Yes
Google Play	Google	$25 one-time	Yes
Domain + email	Any registrar / Google Workspace	Yearly + per user / month	Yes

Not needed any more (Europe corridor dropped): Stripe, TrueLayer/Tink, SEPA, an EU licence, TerraPay and any exchange-rate feed.

Launch checklist

- [ ] BCEAO approval or signed agreement with an approved partner
- [ ] Company registered in a UEMOA country, local bank account open
- [ ] Protected customer-funds account open
- [ ] AML policy written, compliance officer named, CENTIF registration done
- [ ] Data-protection declarations filed; data agreements with every provider
- [ ] Firebase prod + dev on Blaze, budget alert set
- [ ] Firestore security rules reviewed
- [ ] Secrets in Secret Manager, App Check on
- [ ] KYC provider live, webhook updates KYC status
- [ ] CinetPay collection live for Orange, MTN, Moov, Wave
- [ ] CinetPay payout tested in all 8 countries
- [ ] XOF float funded, daily top-up and reconciliation working
- [ ] Bank payout via partner bank tested; PI-SPI access requested
- [ ] Card payments + 3-D Secure tested (if launching cards)
- [ ] SMS OTP delivered on the main operators of every country
- [ ] Receipts by email + push notifications working
- [ ] Sign in with Apple added
- [ ] Store listings in FR + EN approved
- [ ] Pilot with real users in 2–3 countries passed

Sources

- BCEAO Instruction n°001-01-2024 on payment services
- BCEAO list of approved payment institutions, 31 Aug 2026
- BCEAO launch of PI-SPI
- Banking Commission AML Instruction n°001-03-2025
- CinetPay vs Paystack vs Flutterwave fees 2026
- Firebase pricing
- Sumsub vs Onfido pricing 2026